

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Medical Devices English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For medical device engineers, product managers, quality and regulatory staff, clinical specialists, manufacturing teams, field-service teams, and device-company leaders.

Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 User Needs and Design Inputs

Clarify missing information before responding.

02 Risk Management and Hazard Analysis

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

03 Verification, Validation, and Design Review

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

04 Usability and Human Factors

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

05 Regulatory Pathways and Submissions

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

06 Complaints, MDRs, and Postmarket Signals

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

07 Manufacturing, Suppliers, and Nonconformance

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

08 Clinical Training and Labeling Boundaries

State a concern respectfully and propose a practical route forward.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

User Needs and Design Inputs

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

A design brief says the device should be "easy to use." It does not identify the intended users or use environment.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

user need - Something a user needs to accomplish in a particular context.

design input - A documented requirement that guides a product's design.

intended use - The purpose for which a product is designed and represented to be used.

traceability - The ability to follow an item's history, source, requirements, or records through documented links.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Compare this wording: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 01 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when does the review start?
 - B. Could you confirm when starts the review?
 - C. Could you confirm when the review starts?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Who will present the report at the meeting?
 - B. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?
 - C. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Easy to use for whom?

Fictional design-planning meeting: the brief says easy to use but names neither intended users nor the use environment.

01 • Design engineer: The brief says easy to use. Which intended users and environment does that refer to?

02 • Product manager: Those details haven't been defined, so I can't turn that phrase into a reliable design input yet.

03 • Design engineer: Could we assume trained hospital staff, since that would make the requirement easier to draft?

04 • Product manager: No. That would invent a user group and potentially change the intended-use assumptions.

05 • Design engineer: What should we clarify first with the team that supplied the user need?

06 • Product manager: Who performs the task, what task they perform, and the conditions in which they do it.

07 • Design engineer: Then we can discuss measurable design inputs rather than treating easy as a test criterion.

08 • Product manager: Exactly. Keep traceability from the clarified user need to any proposed requirement.

09 • Design engineer: I'll bring those focused questions to the design meeting and leave the input marked unresolved.

10 • Product manager: I'll identify the appropriate user-research source so the team can confirm the scope before drafting acceptance criteria.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A readable screen under which conditions?

Separate fictional device case: a portable reader is intended for trained technicians in a bright clinic room; the brief says readable without specifying distance or display content.

01 • Human factors specialist: We know the users and room conditions. What does readable mean for this portable reader?

02 • Design engineer: The brief doesn't specify viewing distance or which displayed information the technician must distinguish.

03 • Human factors specialist: Could we ask users about the task before choosing a text size as the design input?

04 • Design engineer: Yes. A size selected without task context may not address the actual user need.

05 • Human factors specialist: Should the requirement cover every possible outdoor condition as well as the clinic?

06 • Design engineer: That isn't the supplied intended environment. Any scope expansion needs an explicit review, not an assumption.

07 • Human factors specialist: I'll clarify the viewing task, content, and distance with the intended users.

08 • Design engineer: I'll keep the proposed requirement linked to those findings for traceability.

09 • Human factors specialist: Then our next discussion can address a testable input without promising universal readability.

10 • Design engineer: Agreed. We'll document the confirmed environment and leave untested conditions outside the claim.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A user preference mistaken for an approved input

Separate fictional design review: one technician requested a larger carrying handle; no broader user assessment or approved design input exists.

01 • Product owner: A technician asked for a larger handle. Can we mark that as an approved design input?

02 • Systems engineer: It's a useful user comment, but we haven't assessed the need or approved a requirement.

03 • Product owner: What question would help us understand whether size is the actual problem?

04 • Systems engineer: Ask which carrying task is difficult and under what conditions the current handle causes difficulty.

05 • Product owner: Could the request reflect a personal preference rather than a need shared by every user?

06 • Systems engineer: Possibly. We shouldn't assume either interpretation before reviewing the evidence and intended-use context.

07 • Product owner: I'll preserve the original comment and request a focused follow-up instead of promising a redesign.

08 • Systems engineer: Good. Traceability should show how a reviewed need leads to an input, not just copy a suggestion.

09 • Product owner: I'll bring the clarified task to the design discussion and identify what remains unknown.

10 • Systems engineer: Then we can evaluate options against the actual need without treating one proposed solution as already authorized.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | User Needs and Design Inputs

A design brief says the device should be "easy to use." It does not identify the intended users or use environment.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: Who will use it, for which task, and in what environment? Let's turn "easy to use" into specific user needs and requirements that the team can review.

Scenario 2 | A one-handed requirement without a task

A fictional design brief requests one-handed operation but does not specify which task or why one hand is occupied. The intended users are clinic technicians. Clarify the task before proposing a design input.

Role A: Design engineer: ask which operation must be performed and under what conditions.

Role B: Product specialist: distinguish the stated request from information that still needs user research.

Possible opening: Which task needs one-handed operation, and what is the technician doing with the other hand?

Success checks

- Clarify the task and use conditions.
- Avoid expanding the intended requirement without evidence.
- Agree how the verified need will connect to a testable design input.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to apply the requirement to every device interaction.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Risk Management and Hazard Analysis

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

SITUATION

A risk discussion uses hazard and harm interchangeably. The team needs to describe the potential source of harm and the possible outcome separately.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

hazard - A potential source of harm.

harm - Injury, damage, or another adverse effect on people, property, or the environment.

FMEA - Failure mode and effects analysis, a structured method for identifying how a process or product can fail and prioritizing controls.

residual risk - The risk remaining after controls or other responses are applied.

3. Notice the language

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Compare this wording: We need to operationalize the implementation.

LESSON 02 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Make a complex point clear

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence explains 'backlog' rather than repeating it?
 - A. The backlog is the maximum work the team can finish in a period.
 - B. The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.
 - C. The backlog is the work completed during the last period.
2. Which follow-up best checks whether your explanation was clear?
 - A. How would you describe the next step in your own words?
 - B. Would you like me to repeat the explanation?
 - C. Was the explanation detailed enough for you?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Hazard and harm are not interchangeable

Fictional risk-language exercise: a design worksheet mixes the potential source of harm with the possible resulting injury; no operational safety instructions are practiced.

01 • Risk facilitator: Our worksheet uses hazard and harm as if they mean the same thing. Can we separate them?

02 • Design engineer: A hazard is a potential source of harm; harm is the possible injury or damage.

03 • Risk facilitator: Could we use a hypothetical hot surface and burn to make the distinction concrete?

04 • Design engineer: Yes. The hot surface is the source; a burn is a possible harmful outcome.

05 • Risk facilitator: Does naming both establish that a burn has actually occurred in this device project?

06 • Design engineer: No. This is a hypothetical analysis, not a report of an observed event.

07 • Risk facilitator: Where does residual risk fit when we discuss the proposed risk controls?

08 • Design engineer: It concerns risk remaining after controls; we still need the relevant evaluation rather than assume zero risk.

09 • Risk facilitator: I'll revise the FMEA discussion so the source, sequence, and outcome are distinct.

10 • Design engineer: I'll check the terminology without treating this language example as a completed device-risk assessment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A failure mode is not the resulting injury

Separate fictional FMEA exercise: a display could freeze, an operator could read an outdated value, and an inappropriate decision is a possible downstream consequence; likelihoods are unknown.

01 • Reliability engineer: The worksheet lists display freeze as the injury. That seems to mix different parts of the sequence.

02 • Risk manager: Correct. Display freeze is the proposed failure mode, not an injury by itself.

03 • Reliability engineer: The operator might read an outdated value. Is that the same as proving a harmful outcome?

04 • Risk manager: No. It is part of a potential sequence; the possible consequence needs separate description and assessment.

05 • Reliability engineer: Could we assign a low probability because no event figures are supplied in this exercise?

06 • Risk manager: Missing figures don't establish low likelihood. Keep that information unknown until assessed.

07 • Reliability engineer: I'll separate the failure mode, the use situation, and potential harm in the discussion.

08 • Risk manager: Good. An FMEA can support analysis, but naming a failure doesn't complete the entire risk evaluation.

09 • Reliability engineer: We'll also avoid claiming a proposed control eliminates every downstream possibility.

10 • Risk manager: Agreed. Residual risk needs review after the relevant controls and their evidence are considered.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A control proposed versus a control shown effective

Separate fictional design meeting: a warning label is proposed as a risk control, but no evaluation of its effectiveness has been completed.

01 • Project manager: We added a warning label to the proposal. Can the risk item be called closed?

02 • Risk engineer: A proposed control and an effective control are different statuses; its effectiveness hasn't been evaluated.

03 • Project manager: The label mentions the hazard clearly. Doesn't that remove the possibility of harm?

04 • Risk engineer: We can't infer that. We need to assess the control and any residual risk in context.

05 • Project manager: How should I explain the distinction without making a technical claim about all warning labels?

06 • Risk engineer: Say this control is proposed for review, and its effectiveness is not yet established for this device.

07 • Project manager: Could the design team identify what evidence the risk reviewers need next?

08 • Risk engineer: Yes. Ask for the evaluation plan and acceptance basis through the established design process.

09 • Project manager: I'll leave the risk status open and separate the design action from the assessment outcome.

10 • Risk engineer: I'll coordinate the review so the update reflects evidence, not just the existence of additional text.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Risk Management and Hazard Analysis

A risk discussion uses hazard and harm interchangeably. The team needs to describe the potential source of harm and the possible outcome separately.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: Let's distinguish the hazard from the harm that could result. That will help us describe the sequence clearly and discuss the controls without treating the two terms as synonyms.

Scenario 2 | An event count without an exposure count

A fictional post-design risk discussion mentions two reported incidents but gives no number of devices or uses. The team wants to describe the probability of harm as low. Discuss the missing basis for that statement.

Role A: Risk analyst: explain what the incident count does and does not establish.

Role B: Design manager: ask for the relevant exposure and event definitions before interpreting likelihood.

Possible opening: Two reports tell us the count, but not the probability without an appropriate exposure basis.

Success checks

- Separate event count from probability.
- Do not treat absent reports as proof of zero risk.
- Agree the evidence needed for the risk review.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to enter zero residual risk because no additional reports are known.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Verification, Validation, and Design Review

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

SITUATION

A device team has checked design outputs against specifications but has not yet completed the planned evaluation of intended user needs.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

verification - Checking whether specified requirements have been met.

validation - Confirming that an output or system meets needs for its intended use under defined conditions.

design review - A structured evaluation of a design at a defined stage.

acceptance criteria - Specific conditions a deliverable must meet to be accepted.

3. Notice the language

Use the same time period, scope, and measurement basis for both options. Explain a difference with 'whereas' or 'while'. State what improves and what is given up; do not hide the weaker side of a recommendation.

Both options ..., but

Option A ..., whereas option B

The comparison depends on

Compare this wording: This option is more better.

LESSON 03 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Explain a fair comparison

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence expresses a clear contrast?
 - A. Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.
 - B. Option A is faster because option B costs less.
 - C. Option A is faster, so option B costs less.
2. A rate increases from 6% to 7%. What is the absolute difference?
 - A. An increase of one percent relative to the original rate.
 - B. An increase of seven percentage points.
 - C. An increase of one percentage point.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Specifications checked, user needs still under evaluation

Fictional design review: outputs have been checked against specifications; the planned evaluation of intended user needs is incomplete.

01 • Design manager: We've checked the outputs against specifications. Can we cancel the remaining user-needs evaluation to save time?

02 • Validation lead: Those activities address different questions. Verification checks specifications; validation addresses intended needs in the relevant use context.

03 • Design manager: How should we compare the value of the completed tests and the planned evaluation?

04 • Validation lead: Against their respective objectives and acceptance criteria, not by treating either as a substitute for the other.

05 • Design manager: The remaining evaluation takes longer. Could we call the faster route equally complete?

06 • Validation lead: No. The time saving would leave an identified evidence gap rather than establish equivalent coverage.

07 • Design manager: I'll present completed verification separately and keep the validation activity in the review plan.

08 • Validation lead: Please specify which user-needs questions remain open so the schedule discussion has a concrete basis.

09 • Design manager: I'll ask the design-review team to assess the options without declaring the device fully validated.

10 • Validation lead: Good. We can compare timing and evidence coverage while preserving the different purposes of the work.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Bench timing versus task completion with users

Separate fictional planning case: a bench test measures button response time; a proposed user study measures whether technicians complete the intended setup task.

01 • Test engineer: The bench test is quick. Could we use it instead of the technician setup study?

02 • Human factors lead: It measures button response time, while the study addresses completion of the intended user task.

03 • Test engineer: Both involve the same button. Why aren't their acceptance criteria interchangeable?

04 • Human factors lead: A responsive button doesn't establish that users understand when and how to use it in the task.

05 • Test engineer: How can we compare the two activities fairly when management asks which one to fund?

06 • Human factors lead: Show the question each addresses, evidence coverage, effort, and unresolved gaps if an activity is deferred.

07 • Test engineer: Could we report bench verification complete while leaving the user-task evidence pending?

08 • Human factors lead: Yes, if those statuses match the records. Don't call the pending evidence a passing validation result.

09 • Test engineer: I'll bring that comparison to design review and avoid ranking the options by duration alone.

10 • Human factors lead: I'll identify the intended-user questions so the decision maker sees the actual tradeoff.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A changed criterion breaks a simple pass-rate comparison

Separate fictional verification review: revision A used one acceptance criterion, while revision B uses a different criterion; both have reported pass percentages.

01 • Quality manager: Revision B has a higher pass percentage. Can we say its design is better verified?

02 • Verification engineer: The acceptance criteria changed, so the percentages don't provide a like-for-like comparison.

03 • Quality manager: Could we ignore the change because both reports use the word pass?

04 • Verification engineer: No. Pass means meeting the criterion used in that test, and those criteria differ.

05 • Quality manager: What comparison would let the design-review team understand actual progress and remaining coverage?

06 • Verification engineer: Map the requirements and criteria across revisions, then identify comparable tests and changed evidence needs.

07 • Quality manager: Would rerunning everything be the only possible response to the difference?

08 • Verification engineer: We haven't assessed that. The authorized review should determine the needed work from the changes.

09 • Quality manager: I'll qualify the percentages and ask for a requirement-level comparison before presenting an improvement claim.

10 • Verification engineer: I'll show the differences and uncertainties without treating a higher headline rate as proof of broader validation.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Verification, Validation, and Design Review

A device team has checked design outputs against specifications but has not yet completed the planned evaluation of intended user needs.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You favor one option but have not checked whether the scope is comparable. Ask about one difference, then explain the tradeoff you are willing to accept.

Second round: Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Model for scenario 1: The specification checks address verification. They do not by themselves answer every validation question about intended use. I'll report those activities separately and identify what remains open.

Scenario 2 | Remote and in-person evaluation plans

A fictional device team compares remote and in-person formative evaluation. Remote sessions save travel time, but the proposed remote setup does not reproduce the intended clinic workspace. No equivalence evidence exists. Discuss the scope and tradeoff.

Role A: Study coordinator: explain the practical advantages and missing environmental coverage.

Role B: Validation manager: ask which study questions each setup can address before recommending a plan.

Possible opening: Remote sessions reduce travel, but this setup doesn't reproduce the intended workspace.

Success checks

- Compare plans against the same intended questions.
- Keep environmental limitations explicit.
- Avoid claiming equivalence or final validation from an unassessed plan.

Add a complication: A sponsor wants both plans labeled equivalent validation options without review.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Usability and Human Factors

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

Several participants misread a label in a formative usability study. A draft report describes them as careless.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

human factors - The study and application of knowledge about how people interact with products, tasks, and environments.

use error - An action or omission during use that leads to a different result from the intended one; context and design matter.

formative study - An evaluation used during development to identify problems and improve a design.

summative study - An evaluation conducted to assess performance against defined requirements after development work.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 04 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change must have caused the delay.
 - B. The change definitely caused the delay.
 - C. The change may have contributed to the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. Across the service, the observed result was ...
 - B. In this pilot, the observed result was ...
 - C. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Misread labels without calling participants careless

Fictional formative usability review: several participants misread a label, but the report supplies no evidence about motivation or attentiveness.

01 • Usability researcher: The draft says participants were careless. Our observation was that several misread the label.

02 • Design lead: Could carelessness be a reasonable explanation for the use error in this formative study?

03 • Usability researcher: It is an untested interpretation, not an observed fact. We should investigate the interaction and context.

04 • Design lead: What description would help the team act without assigning blame to the participants?

05 • Usability researcher: State which label was misread, during which task, and what the participants actually did.

06 • Design lead: Those detailed observations need checking against the study records before we add them.

07 • Usability researcher: Exactly. Don't invent the sequence or a cause just to complete the paragraph.

08 • Design lead: Could we already describe this as a failed summative study because use errors occurred?

09 • Usability researcher: No. This was formative work, and its purpose and evidence must be described accurately.

10 • Design lead: I'll remove the blame language and request the observed task details for a focused human-factors review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Four pauses are an observation, not a diagnosis of confusion

Separate fictional formative study: four of eight technicians paused before selecting a menu item; interviews about their reasons are not yet reviewed.

01 • Product manager: Four of eight technicians paused. Can we say half the users were confused by the menu?

02 • Human factors researcher: We observed pauses, but haven't reviewed their explanations. Confusion is not yet established.

03 • Product manager: Would the timing alone show that the interface caused the hesitation during the task?

04 • Human factors researcher: It identifies behavior to investigate, not the cause by itself.

05 • Product manager: How should the finding describe the sample without generalizing to every intended user?

06 • Human factors researcher: Say four of eight participants in this formative study paused before selection, with reasons still under review.

07 • Product manager: Could we pair that observation with the interview evidence once you've checked it?

08 • Human factors researcher: Yes. Keep participant reports distinct from observed actions and our interpretation.

09 • Product manager: I'll remove the half of all users headline and preserve the actual study count.

10 • Human factors researcher: I'll review the accounts and identify which design questions are supported, without assuming a particular use-error mechanism.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Moderator help limits an unaided-success claim

Separate fictional usability session: one participant completed a setup task after the moderator gave a hint; unaided completion was not observed for that attempt.

01 • Study coordinator: The participant finished the task. Can I count this attempt as unaided success?

02 • Usability specialist: No. The moderator gave a hint, so the completion occurred with assistance.

03 • Study coordinator: The hint was short. Could we leave it out because the participant performed the final action?

04 • Usability specialist: That would remove context relevant to interpretation. Record both the assistance and the observed completion.

05 • Study coordinator: Does the assisted attempt prove that every user would fail without help?

06 • Usability specialist: No. That broader conclusion isn't supported by this single formative observation.

07 • Study coordinator: I'll label the attempt assisted and preserve the moderator's wording in the study record.

08 • Usability specialist: Good. Any summary should follow the study's definitions rather than silently change the success category.

09 • Study coordinator: Should we discuss the unanswered unaided-task question at the next human-factors review?

10 • Usability specialist: Yes. Identify the evidence gap and appropriate follow-up without relabeling this attempt as a summative validation result.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Usability and Human Factors

Several participants misread a label in a formative usability study. A draft report describes them as careless.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: The observed difficulty was reading the label correctly in this study. Let's describe the task, design, and use conditions, then investigate contributing factors without assuming carelessness.

Scenario 2 | A corrected click after a wrong selection

In a fictional formative study, a participant selects the wrong menu item, notices it, and corrects the selection without help. The draft says no use errors occurred. Discuss how to preserve both the error and recovery.

Role A: Usability observer: describe the observed sequence without attributing a cause.

Role B: Design reviewer: ask how recovery should be represented under the study definitions.

Possible opening: The participant recovered independently, but the initial wrong selection still occurred.

Success checks

- Describe both the initial selection and unaided recovery.
- Avoid claiming either flawless use or universal failure.
- Agree to use the study definitions and retain the full observed sequence.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to omit the first selection because the final screen was correct.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Regulatory Pathways and Submissions

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

SITUATION

A presentation refers to a proposed device pathway as settled, although the regulatory team is still evaluating options.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

510(k) - US FDA premarket submission that typically demonstrates substantial equivalence to a legally marketed predicate device.

De Novo - A US FDA classification process for certain novel devices without a legally marketed predicate.

PMA - Premarket approval: the US FDA review pathway for certain high-risk medical devices.

predicate device - A legally marketed device used as a comparison in an applicable US FDA submission.

3. Notice the language

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Compare this wording: Please revert soonest with the necessary.

LESSON 05 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask for an actionable next step

4. Check the language

1. What does 'Please send it by Thursday' normally mean?
 - A. Keep sending it regularly until Thursday.
 - B. Send it no later than Thursday.
 - C. Send it on Thursday, but not earlier.
2. Which request gives the recipient enough detail to act?
 - A. Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?
 - B. Could you confirm that the review is important?
 - C. Could you confirm that you received my earlier message?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Request a pathway assessment, not a presumed route

Fictional submission planning: a slide presents the proposed device pathway as settled, although regulatory specialists are still evaluating options.

01 • Project manager: The slide presents our proposed pathway as settled. What confirmation should I request before using it?

02 • Regulatory lead: Ask for the current assessment, supporting assumptions, and unresolved questions from the regulatory team.

03 • Project manager: Could I leave 510(k) as confirmed because it is already printed in the timeline?

04 • Regulatory lead: No. A planning label doesn't establish that route or an agency outcome.

05 • Project manager: What specific action do you need from the product team for the assessment?

06 • Regulatory lead: Please confirm the current device description and intended use before our internal review meeting.

07 • Project manager: Should the slide list De Novo and PMA as equally appropriate alternatives while review continues?

08 • Regulatory lead: Not unless assessed. We can say pathway under evaluation without inventing a ranking or conclusion.

09 • Project manager: I'll correct the status and send the requested product information for review.

10 • Regulatory lead: I'll return a scoped assessment and identify which questions need further specialist or agency clarification.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A similar product is not a confirmed predicate

Separate fictional regulatory exercise: a competitor's brochure describes a superficially similar device; no predicate assessment has been completed.

01 • Commercial manager: This brochure looks similar to our device. Can we identify it as our confirmed predicate?

02 • Regulatory specialist: Not from the brochure alone. We need the relevant device information and a regulatory assessment.

03 • Commercial manager: What can I request from our research team before tomorrow's strategy discussion?

04 • Regulatory specialist: Ask for the source documents supporting the comparison, including the device identity and intended-use information.

05 • Commercial manager: Would sharing the same marketing category prove suitability for a 510(k) strategy?

06 • Regulatory specialist: No. A marketing category is not a completed predicate-device analysis.

07 • Commercial manager: I'll call it a candidate for assessment rather than a selected predicate in the briefing.

08 • Regulatory specialist: Please also identify gaps instead of filling missing technical characteristics from appearance or promotional language.

09 • Commercial manager: I'll send the documented comparison questions today and request an initial review status.

10 • Regulatory specialist: I'll assess what is available and explain the next evidence needs without promising a pathway conclusion.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A design change needs a scoped regulatory question

Separate fictional planning call: a team proposes changing the device's intended user group; regulatory implications have not been reviewed.

01 • Development director: Can the regulatory team confirm that this user-group change has no submission implications?

02 • Regulatory strategist: Please frame it as an assessment request, not a request to endorse an assumed answer.

03 • Development director: What information would make the request focused enough for the team to act?

04 • Regulatory strategist: Provide the current and proposed user groups, intended tasks, and the related design-change description.

05 • Development director: Could we assume the original pathway remains unchanged because the hardware isn't changing?

06 • Regulatory strategist: We shouldn't infer that. The intended-use context needs review even if the hardware description stays the same.

07 • Development director: I'll request the assessment before we finalize the project plan, with the changes clearly compared.

08 • Regulatory strategist: Good. Ask for an initial scope and timing estimate rather than an immediate blanket assurance.

09 • Development director: I'll leave the pathway implications open and avoid making a 510(k), De Novo, or PMA claim.

10 • Regulatory strategist: I'll coordinate the relevant review and return the verified planning implications when the assessment is available.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Regulatory Pathways and Submissions

A presentation refers to a proposed device pathway as settled, although the regulatory team is still evaluating options.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Please label the pathway as under evaluation and identify the questions for the regulatory team. We should distinguish a proposed approach from a confirmed regulatory conclusion.

Scenario 2 | A submission date confused with an outcome date

A fictional project calendar targets submission on 1 October. No review duration or agency decision date is confirmed. A launch slide calls 1 October the clearance date. Request a correction and a scoped regulatory planning review.

Role A: Program coordinator: identify the calendar mismatch and request accurate wording.

Role B: Regulatory manager: distinguish a planned submission from an unconfirmed agency outcome.

Possible opening: October first is our submission target, not a confirmed clearance date.

Success checks

- Separate the team's filing target from agency decision timing.
- Request correction of the specific claim.
- Agree the review owner without inventing a regulatory timeline.

Add a complication: Sales asks to keep the date because customers have already seen the draft.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Complaints, MDRs, and Postmarket Signals

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

SITUATION

A complaint report describes a malfunction but lacks the device identifier and event date. The complaint-handling team needs the available facts promptly.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

complaint - An expression of dissatisfaction requiring attention under a relevant process.

MDR - Medical Device Reporting; the US FDA system for specified device-event reports; elsewhere the acronym may refer to a regulation.

malfunction - A failure of a product or system to operate as intended.

postmarket surveillance - Collecting and evaluating information about a product after it enters the market.

3. Notice the language

State the current situation, relevant background, open task, and receiving role. Ask for acknowledgment or repeat-back of the critical item. Sending a message and transferring responsibility are not always the same thing.

The current status is ...; the outstanding item is

The record shows

Please confirm who has accepted

Compare this wording: Someone should follow up on this.

LESSON 06 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Transfer information and responsibility

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence checks that responsibility has been accepted?
 - A. Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check.
 - B. I mentioned the check in my earlier email.
 - C. The check appears somewhere in the notes.
2. Which response best checks a critical handoff detail?
 - A. I assume all results are final, so we can finish.
 - B. I saw the message, so no clarification is needed.
 - C. So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A malfunction complaint with missing identifiers

Fictional complaint handoff: a malfunction is reported, but the device identifier and event date are missing; no reportability assessment exists.

01 • Customer support specialist: I'm handing over a reported malfunction; the device identifier and event date are still missing.

02 • Complaint investigator: Please pass the available account now through our complaint channel and label those gaps explicitly.

03 • Customer support specialist: Should I wait until the reporter provides both details before you receive the complaint?

04 • Complaint investigator: Don't delay this handoff for completeness. Follow our process for transferring known facts and requesting follow-up.

05 • Customer support specialist: Can I label it a confirmed MDR event to make the urgency clear?

06 • Complaint investigator: No reportability assessment is established here. Keep the complaint description separate from that authorized determination.

07 • Customer support specialist: I'll preserve the reporter's wording and avoid inventing the model or event date.

08 • Complaint investigator: I'll take ownership of investigation intake and coordinate the missing-information request.

09 • Customer support specialist: Please confirm that your team received the handoff so I don't assume responsibility transferred.

10 • Complaint investigator: Confirmed. We'll assess the available facts and keep the unresolved identifier, date, and reporting questions visible.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A second report may describe the same event

Separate fictional postmarket case: distributor and clinic reports mention the same device reference and date; whether they describe one event or two is unconfirmed.

01 • Postmarket analyst: We received two reports with the same device reference and date. I'm flagging a possible duplicate.

02 • Complaint coordinator: Have you confirmed that they describe one event rather than separate malfunctions?

03 • Postmarket analyst: No. The matching details suggest a check, but they don't establish duplication by themselves.

04 • Complaint coordinator: Please link both reports for review without deleting either account from the record.

05 • Postmarket analyst: Should the surveillance count show two confirmed events while the check is pending?

06 • Complaint coordinator: Distinguish reports received from verified event count so the uncertainty isn't hidden.

07 • Postmarket analyst: I'll hand over both source references and identify which details match.

08 • Complaint coordinator: I'll own the reconciliation and route any reporting assessment through the responsible team.

09 • Postmarket analyst: Can you return the verified relationship before I finalize the postmarket surveillance summary?

10 • Complaint coordinator: Yes. I'll report the reconciliation status without assuming either duplication or two independent events in advance.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A returned device does not complete the investigation

Separate fictional complaint case: the returned device has arrived at the laboratory, but examination and causality review have not started.

01 • Service coordinator: The returned device arrived this morning. I'm transferring the case to the investigation laboratory.

02 • Investigation engineer: Thank you. Receipt is confirmed, but examination and any causal assessment are still pending.

03 • Service coordinator: Could customer support say the reported malfunction has been verified now that we have the device?

04 • Investigation engineer: No. Possession of the device isn't confirmation of the reported behavior or its cause.

05 • Service coordinator: I'll pass the complaint reference and maintain the distinction between receipt and examination.

06 • Investigation engineer: Please include the available custody information through the case system so the handoff is traceable.

07 • Service coordinator: Who will return an update for the customer's next inquiry about investigation progress?

08 • Investigation engineer: I'll own the laboratory status update, while the complaint team retains its overall coordination role.

09 • Service coordinator: I'll tell support the device is received and assessment remains pending, without predicting findings.

10 • Investigation engineer: Correct. I'll confirm the next verified status and keep any MDR assessment with the authorized reporting team.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Complaints, MDRs, and Postmarket Signals

A complaint report describes a malfunction but lacks the device identifier and event date. The complaint-handling team needs the available facts promptly.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are taking over the work. Ask what remains open and repeat back the critical status or responsibility. Point out one detail that would be unsafe or misleading to assume.

Second round: The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Model for scenario 1: Here is the reported malfunction and the information currently available. The device identifier and event date are missing. Please confirm receipt and handle follow-up through the complaint process.

Scenario 2 | A reporter changes the device reference

In a fictional complaint case, the reporter withdraws the original device reference and supplies a photo that has not been reviewed. The correct identifier remains unconfirmed. Hand the correction to the complaint team without overwriting the history.

Role A: Technical support specialist: distinguish the withdrawn identifier from the unreviewed photo.

Role B: Complaint coordinator: confirm receipt and assign identifier verification.

Possible opening: The reporter says the original reference was wrong; the photo may help, but its identifier has not been verified.

Success checks

- Do not guess the device identity.
- Preserve the correction and source history.
- Confirm the owner of verification and keep reportability decisions separate.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests entering the most common model as a temporary fact.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Manufacturing, Suppliers, and Nonconformance

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

SITUATION

An incoming-material review has identified two nonconforming lots. The investigation is open and disposition has not been authorized.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

nonconformance - Failure to meet a requirement, specification, contract, standard, or approved procedure.

supplier CAPA - A supplier's corrective and preventive action process for addressing identified quality problems and recurrence risks.

process validation - Documented evidence that a process can consistently produce results meeting specified requirements.

lot traceability - Ability to follow a production lot through materials, process steps, tools, inspections, and downstream customers or products.

3. Notice the language

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Compare this wording: Everything is progressing well.

LESSON 07 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Give a useful status update

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence says a review is finished?
 - A. The team is completing the review.
 - B. The team plans to complete the review.
 - C. The team has completed the review.
2. Which update distinguishes a plan from a confirmed fact?
 - A. The delivery plan proves that arrival will be Friday.
 - B. Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.
 - C. Delivery is confirmed for Friday because we planned it.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Two nonconforming lots still await disposition

Fictional incoming-material review: two lots are identified as nonconforming; investigation is open and disposition is unauthorized.

01 • Production planner: Two lots were inspected. Can I show the incoming-material issue as resolved on the schedule?

02 • Supplier quality engineer: No. Both lots are identified as nonconforming, and the investigation and disposition remain open.

03 • Production planner: The inspection is finished, though. What completed work can I accurately report?

04 • Supplier quality engineer: The nonconformance was identified in two lots. That doesn't establish authorization to use or release them.

05 • Production planner: Should I assume the supplier CAPA is complete because we've sent them the findings?

06 • Supplier quality engineer: No. Sending findings is a communication step, not evidence of completed corrective action.

07 • Production planner: I'll keep material availability unconfirmed and ask for the next investigation update.

08 • Supplier quality engineer: Please preserve the two lot references so the planning discussion maintains lot traceability.

09 • Production planner: I'll link the records and avoid substituting another lot without a separate verified decision.

10 • Supplier quality engineer: I'll communicate any authorized status change and distinguish it from our ongoing assessment activities.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A supplier response is not an accepted CAPA

Separate fictional quality case: a supplier submitted a corrective-action response for lot D12, but the receiving quality team has not reviewed it.

01 • Procurement lead: The supplier sent its CAPA response for D12. Can I mark the issue closed?

02 • Quality reviewer: Receipt is complete, but our review and any acceptance decision are still pending.

03 • Procurement lead: They wrote resolved in the response. Doesn't that settle the status for our dashboard?

04 • Quality reviewer: That is the supplier's statement, not a completed assessment by the responsible receiving team.

05 • Procurement lead: What distinction should I communicate to production while the review continues?

06 • Quality reviewer: Supplier response received, assessment pending, and no new material-use authorization established by this exchange.

07 • Procurement lead: I'll retain the response against the nonconformance record rather than replace our status with their wording.

08 • Quality reviewer: Good. Keep lot traceability so the response isn't accidentally applied to unrelated material.

09 • Procurement lead: Can you provide a review-status checkpoint once an owner has confirmed the work?

10 • Quality reviewer: Yes. I'll report the verified next step without treating a supplier declaration as proof of effectiveness or closure.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Process trials complete, validation review pending

Separate fictional manufacturing update: three planned process trials have been executed, but the process-validation report has not been reviewed.

01 • Manufacturing manager: All three trials ran. Can the status slide say the process is validated?

02 • Validation engineer: Execution is complete, but the process-validation report still awaits review.

03 • Manufacturing manager: Would changing the phrase to fully tested avoid that approval issue?

04 • Validation engineer: It could still overstate the scope. Say the three planned trials were executed, with review pending.

05 • Manufacturing manager: Do we have a confirmed conclusion about acceptance criteria from the information supplied here?

06 • Validation engineer: No. We should not invent a pass, a failure, or an authorized manufacturing decision.

07 • Manufacturing manager: I'll distinguish completed trial activity from the unconfirmed assessment and its production implications.

08 • Validation engineer: Please keep the material and lot references available so the trial evidence remains traceable.

09 • Manufacturing manager: I'll ask for the next review checkpoint rather than promise routine production availability.

10 • Validation engineer: I'll provide that status when confirmed and identify any remaining evidence needs without announcing an outcome prematurely.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Manufacturing, Suppliers, and Nonconformance

An incoming-material review has identified two nonconforming lots. The investigation is open and disposition has not been authorized.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Second round: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for scenario 1: Two lots have open nonconformance records. The investigation and disposition are still pending. I'll report their status without implying that release or rejection has already been approved.

Scenario 2 | A lot reference missing from the inspection attachment

A fictional inspection summary says one lot passed, but its attached measurement sheet has no lot reference. The linkage is unverified and no new release decision is supplied. Explain completed work and the unresolved traceability question.

Role A: Incoming inspector: report the missing linkage without assuming the measurements belong to the stated lot.

Role B: Quality coordinator: assign verification and keep the status appropriately qualified.

Possible opening: The summary names a lot, but we have not verified that this measurement sheet belongs to it.

Success checks

- Identify the precise lot-traceability gap.
- Do not assign evidence by guesswork.
- Agree the verification owner without implying release authority.

Add a complication: A planner asks you to attach the sheet to the nearest lot number in the system.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Clinical Training and Labeling Boundaries

State a concern respectfully and propose a practical route forward.

SITUATION

A trainer is asked to demonstrate a use beyond the materials approved for the session.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

labeling - The information supplied with or about a regulated product, as defined by applicable rules.

instructions for use - The manufacturer's information explaining the intended use and operation of a device.

off-label - A use outside a regulated product's approved or cleared labeling, as applicable to that product and jurisdiction.

clinical evidence - Information from clinical evaluation or research relevant to a health-related question.

3. Notice the language

Acknowledge the goal without pretending agreement. Name the specific problem and its implication, then ask a focused question or propose a next step. Be direct when a safety or ethical boundary requires it.

I understand the goal. My concern is

That statement goes beyond

Could we ... before confirming ...?

Compare this wording: That idea is ridiculous.

LESSON 08 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Disagree with a useful reason

4. Check the language

1. Which response identifies a specific assumption and evidence against it?
 - A. I would like another discussion before we proceed with the proposal.
 - B. The proposal assumes the review is complete; the record shows it is still open.
 - C. The proposal appears optimistic, and I would prefer a slower approach.
2. Which follow-up makes disagreement actionable?
 - A. Could we resolve the missing approval before confirming the plan?
 - B. Could we confirm the plan and discuss the missing approval later?
 - C. Could we ask for general feedback before sending the next update?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A demonstration outside the session materials

Fictional clinical-training session: a trainer is asked to demonstrate a use beyond the approved session materials; no procedure is taught in this language exercise.

01 • Clinical trainer: That requested demonstration is outside the materials approved for this session.

02 • Training coordinator: Could you show it briefly and say it isn't part of the standard training?

03 • Clinical trainer: My concern is that the demonstration would still go beyond our reviewed scope and supporting instructions.

04 • Training coordinator: What can we offer so the question is acknowledged rather than simply dismissed?

05 • Clinical trainer: Capture the specific inquiry and refer it through the appropriate medical or regulatory review channel.

06 • Training coordinator: Does calling it off-label mean we can answer freely as long as we use that term?

07 • Clinical trainer: No. The label doesn't itself establish an appropriate response or the clinical evidence needed.

08 • Training coordinator: I'll keep today's practice within the supplied instructions for use and flag the separate question.

09 • Clinical trainer: Thank you. We should not improvise a clinical technique or claim outside the reviewed materials.

10 • Training coordinator: I'll confirm the referral owner and avoid promising that the requested demonstration will be approved.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An older training deck conflicts with the current packet

Separate fictional training review: an older deck contains a step absent from the current approved session packet; the reason for the difference is unknown.

01 • Training manager: The older deck includes an extra step. Could we add it back to make today's session familiar?

02 • Clinical education specialist: We need the discrepancy reviewed first. Familiarity doesn't establish that the older step belongs in this session.

03 • Training manager: Can we assume it was removed accidentally rather than as an intentional labeling change?

04 • Clinical education specialist: Neither explanation is confirmed. Preserve both references and ask the responsible owner to clarify.

05 • Training manager: What should the trainer do while the packet difference is unresolved?

06 • Clinical education specialist: Keep to the verified session scope and avoid improvising the disputed content.

07 • Training manager: I'll request a comparison with the applicable instructions for use before revising the deck.

08 • Clinical education specialist: Good. A training edit should not silently create a new instruction or broader use claim.

09 • Training manager: I'll tell the trainer the extra step is under review, not confirmed as correct or incorrect.

10 • Clinical education specialist: I'll coordinate the clarification and return reviewed wording rather than let the team choose between versions informally.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A testimonial is not comparative clinical evidence

Separate fictional education-material review: a slide says the device is safer than alternatives based only on one clinician's favorable comment.

01 • Sales educator: The clinician praised the device. Can our training slide say it is safer than alternatives?

02 • Clinical evidence reviewer: That comparative safety claim goes beyond a single favorable comment and needs appropriate supporting evidence.

03 • Sales educator: Could we place the comment in quotation marks and keep the same safety headline?

04 • Clinical evidence reviewer: Quotation marks don't supply evidence for the headline. We need to assess the actual claim.

05 • Sales educator: What can I use for the session while that assessment is pending?

06 • Clinical evidence reviewer: Stay within the reviewed labeling and session materials, and route the proposed comparison for review.

07 • Sales educator: Should I describe the absence of evidence here as proof the device is less safe?

08 • Clinical evidence reviewer: No. Neither comparative conclusion is established by the supplied comment.

09 • Sales educator: I'll remove the unsupported headline and keep the clinician's comment out of this draft pending review.

10 • Clinical evidence reviewer: I'll assess the proposed content and clarify the evidence boundary without promising approval of a comparative claim.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Clinical Training and Labeling Boundaries

A trainer is asked to demonstrate a use beyond the materials approved for the session.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You want to move quickly and initially overlook a relevant condition. Ask why it matters, then consider a practical route forward that respects the real constraint.

Second round: The other person repeats the request more firmly. Restate the specific concern calmly and explain the appropriate next route.

Model for scenario 1: That request goes beyond the approved training material for this session. I can cover the authorized instructions and route the additional question to the appropriate team for review.

Scenario 2 | A requested shortcut to fit the training slot

A fictional coordinator asks a trainer to omit one section from the approved device-training packet to finish ten minutes earlier. The section's purpose and omission implications have not been assessed. Negotiate a review of timing without changing the instructions yourself.

Role A: Clinical trainer: explain the scope concern and propose checking an approved shorter session format.

Role B: Training coordinator: describe the timing constraint and agree to obtain the responsible review.

Possible opening: I can discuss the timing, but I can't assume this section can be omitted without review.

Success checks

- Avoid assuming experience removes the need for reviewed content.
- Keep the session within authorized materials.
- Agree a practical timing or review route without improvising device instructions.

Add a complication: The organizer says experienced participants never need the omitted material.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | User Needs and Design Inputs

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Check 1: C - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

B: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

C: The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".

Check 2: B - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

B: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

C: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

Model response: Who will use it, for which task, and in what environment? Let's turn "easy to use" into specific user needs and requirements that the team can review.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Risk Management and Hazard Analysis

Editing example: We need to put the plan into practice.

The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Check 1: B - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.

A: This describes capacity, not the work waiting to be completed.

B: This gives the meaning in familiar words.

C: Completed work is different from work still waiting.

Check 2: A - How would you describe the next step in your own words?

A: An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

B: Offering repetition may help, but it does not show how the listener understood the next step.

C: This invites an opinion on detail, not a demonstration of understanding.

Model response: Let's distinguish the hazard from the harm that could result. That will help us describe the sequence clearly and discuss the controls without treating the two terms as synonyms.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Verification, Validation, and Design Review

Editing example: This option is better on cost, but slower to deliver.

'Better' already has comparative meaning, so it does not need 'more'. Naming the criterion and tradeoff makes the comparison useful.

Check 1: A - Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.

A: 'Whereas' marks a contrast between two options.

B: 'Because' claims a causal connection that is not given.

C: 'So' implies one fact causes the other.

Check 2: C - An increase of one percentage point.

A: A one-percent relative increase on 6% would be 6.06%, not 7%.

B: The new rate is 7%; the difference between the rates is one percentage point.

C: Subtracting 6% from 7% gives one percentage point. The relative increase is about 16.7%.

Model response: The specification checks address verification. They do not by themselves answer every validation question about intended use. I'll report those activities separately and identify what remains open.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Usability and Human Factors

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: C - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

B: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

C: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

Check 2: B - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

B: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

C: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

Model response: The observed difficulty was reading the label correctly in this study. Let's describe the task, design, and use conditions, then investigate contributing factors without assuming carelessness.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Regulatory Pathways and Submissions

Editing example: Could you send the missing document and confirm when it will be available?

The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Check 1: B - Send it no later than Thursday.

A: This interprets a deadline as a continuing activity, which would use "until".

B: 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.

C: "By Thursday" permits earlier delivery; it is not restricted to that day.

Check 2: A - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

A: The requested action and information are explicit.

B: This checks importance rather than identifying the needed document version.

C: This checks receipt, not which version is required for the review.

Model response: Please label the pathway as under evaluation and identify the questions for the regulatory team. We should distinguish a proposed approach from a confirmed regulatory conclusion.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Complaints, MDRs, and Postmarket Signals

Editing example: Please confirm which team has accepted the follow-up task.

The revised sentence asks for an identifiable receiving team instead of leaving responsibility with an unspecified 'someone'.

Check 1: A - Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check.

A: It asks for an identifiable person or team responsible for the task.

B: Mentioning a task does not show that anyone accepted it.

C: A written record alone does not identify who will act.

Check 2: C - So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct?

A: It changes pending information into a final result.

B: Receiving a message is not the same as confirming its meaning.

C: This repeats the status and responsibility and invites correction.

Model response: Here is the reported malfunction and the information currently available. The device identifier and event date are missing. Please confirm receipt and handle follow-up through the complaint process.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Manufacturing, Suppliers, and Nonconformance

Editing example: Three checks are complete; two remain open and are being reviewed.

The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Check 1: C - The team has completed the review.

A: 'Is completing' presents the work as in progress.

B: 'Plans to complete' describes an intention, not completion.

C: 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.

Check 2: B - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

A: A plan cannot prove a future arrival time.

B: This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

C: A plan does not establish carrier confirmation.

Model response: Two lots have open nonconformance records. The investigation and disposition are still pending. I'll report their status without implying that release or rejection has already been approved.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Clinical Training and Labeling Boundaries

Editing example: My concern is that the proposal assumes capacity we have not confirmed.

The revised sentence identifies a testable concern about the proposal. It leaves room for a constructive response.

Check 1: B - The proposal assumes the review is complete; the record shows it is still open.

A: This requests discussion without stating the specific assumption or evidence.

B: It connects the concern to a specific assumption and record.

C: This expresses a preference, but does not identify the assumption or the record that contradicts it.

Check 2: A - Could we resolve the missing approval before confirming the plan?

A: It names the unresolved condition and a practical next step.

B: This confirms the plan before resolving the stated approval condition.

C: General feedback does not directly address the missing approval.

Model response: That request goes beyond the approved training material for this session. I can cover the authorized instructions and route the additional question to the appropriate team for review.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

FDA: De Novo classification

<https://www.fda.gov/medical-devices/premarket-submissions-selecting-and-preparing-correct-submission/de-novo-classification-request>

FDA: Medical Device Reporting

<https://www.fda.gov/medical-devices/medical-device-safety/medical-device-reporting-mdr-how-report-medical-device-problems>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Medical Devices English

Professional audience: medical device engineers, product managers, quality and regulatory staff, clinical specialists, manufacturing teams, field-service teams, and device-company leaders

Scope: Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

Lesson 01: User Needs and Design Inputs

Original fictional case: A design brief says the device should be "easy to use." It does not identify the intended users or use environment.

Language workshop: Ask a precise question

Communication goal: Clarify missing information before responding.

Language guidance: Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): When you say ..., do you mean ...? / Could you clarify which ...? / So, my understanding is Is that right?

Vocabulary: user need: Something a user needs to accomplish in a particular context. / design input: A documented requirement that guides a product's design. / intended use: The purpose for which a product is designed and represented to be used. / traceability: The ability to follow an item's history, source, requirements, or records through documented links.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Who will use it, for which task, and in what environment? Let's turn "easy to use" into specific user needs and requirements that the team can review.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Grammar that changes the meaning

1. For a lesson, use its language workshop as the focus. For a dialogue, quote one actual sentence and select one useful grammar feature from it, such as question word order, tense, modality, conditionals or clause linking. Explain in no more than 90 words how this feature helps the speakers do their work. Keep the grammar target narrow.
2. Give two short contrasting sentences using this workplace context. Explain the difference in time, certainty, condition or politeness. Label invented examples and preserve the distinction between possible, planned and confirmed events. Describe context-dependent choices as choices, not universal rules.
3. Give me one editing or sentence-building task using a known case fact. Do not copy the supplied editing example or reveal its answer. Ask me to explain my intended meaning. Stop and wait.
4. After I answer, quote my wording, identify at most two issues, and give a brief explanation and one hint. Ask me to revise before offering a full corrected version. Then accept any accurate, natural alternative that serves the purpose.
5. Continue with two new tasks, one at a time: first guided, then an original response without a sentence frame. End with a two-sentence workplace message using the target feature and a compact self-check. Do not replace this sequence with a worksheet and answer key.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level